

FLEET RULE OF THE ROAD TEST FOR NOV 2018

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(G) Vol II, NP735 and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

PART 1

1. Describe an easterly cardinal mark, including colour, shape, topmark and light characteristics. **(NP375) (2)**.

2. The Rules shall not interfere with the operation of special rules made by whom and in what areas? **(R1b) (2)**

3. Nothing in the Rules shall exonerate the CO and/or OOW from the consequences of what? **(R2a) (2)**

4. To what should due regard be had when construing and complying with these Rules?**(R2b) (2)**

5. How do the Rules describe a proper lookout?**(R5) (3)**

6. The term restricted visibility means what?(**R3l**) (1)

7. Where should a vessel keep her course along a narrow channel?(**R9a**) (1)

8. Rule 8f(i) & 8f(ii) mention vessels that are *not to impede the passage or safe passage of another vessel*. Name three such vessels with the associated circumstances. (**R9 b, c & d, R10i, j and R18di**) (3)

9. When required by the circumstances of the case, how should a vessel required not to impede the passage or safe passage of another vessel act? (**R8f(i)**) (2)

10. If the circumstances of the case admit, how should any action taken to avoid collision be? (**R8a**) (1)

11. When two PDVs are meeting on reciprocal or nearly reciprocal courses so as to involve risk of collision, what action shall they take? When shall such a situation be deemed to exist? (**R14 a & b**) (3)

12. Describe the lights displayed by a vessel engaged in trawling (greater than 20m in length) when hauling her nets in close proximity to other vessels engaged in fishing?(**R26 b(i), d and annex II) (3)**)

Part 1

____/25

Part 2

You are the Navigating Officer of a T23 (length 133m) sailing from Portsmouth to conduct FRE tasking in the North Sea. The area is sitting under the influence of a high pressure which is giving both fine weather and foggy periods.

13. During the departure from the Solent, visibility becomes restricted. What do the rules state about your machinery state? **(R19b) (1)**

14. When should your navigation lights be illuminated? **(R20 b) (1)**

15. The CO asks you what six considerations for determining safe speed should be taken into account by vessels with operational radar – what are they? **(R6b) (6)**

16. Your lookout reports he has heard sound signals forward of the beam, consisting of 1 prolonged followed by 2 short blasts at intervals not less than 2 minutes. You do not have it on radar and it is the first time it has been heard. Describe your reactions. **(R19e) (2)**

17. Not long after the sound signals above were heard, you pick up a radar contact at red 20 at 2nm and you assess it correlates with the sound signals. It is proceeding along the same course and speed as you; you are due to alter course to port in 2c time. Do the Rules permit you to alter to port in this instance? **(R19d&e) (2)**

18. Visibility clears and you continue to navigate through the TSS. At Green 20, Range 6 miles you sight a cross-channel ferry. Its bearing is steady and it is crossing the TSS, you are on her port bow.

a. Which vessel should keep out of the way? **(R15) (1)**

b. What would be your preferred action to avoid collision in this case when there are numerous vessels on your port and starboard sides? **(R8e) (1)**

19. The ferry passes clear and you continue on your transit through the TSS. At green 20 you see a beam-trawler fishing and her track is leading directly into the TSS. What do the rules state about this vessel's conduct within the TSS and what shapes would you expect to see? **(R.10i & R.26bi) (2)**

a. If risk of collision exists who would be the give way vessel? **(R18a) (1)**

20. At red 45 you see a ferry crossing the TSS, how, relative to the TSS, do you expect her to cross? **(R10c) (2)**

a. You determine the ferry is on a steady bearing. Who is the give-way vessel? **(R15) (1)**

b. You assess the ferry is not taking appropriate action to keep out of the way. When may, and when shall you take action, and in taking action, what should be avoided? **(R17aii, b, c) (4)**

c. What sound signal would be appropriate in this situation? **(R34d) (1)**

Part 2
TOTAL

_____/25
_____/50